

TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE AND CHANDELLA-KHAJURAHO

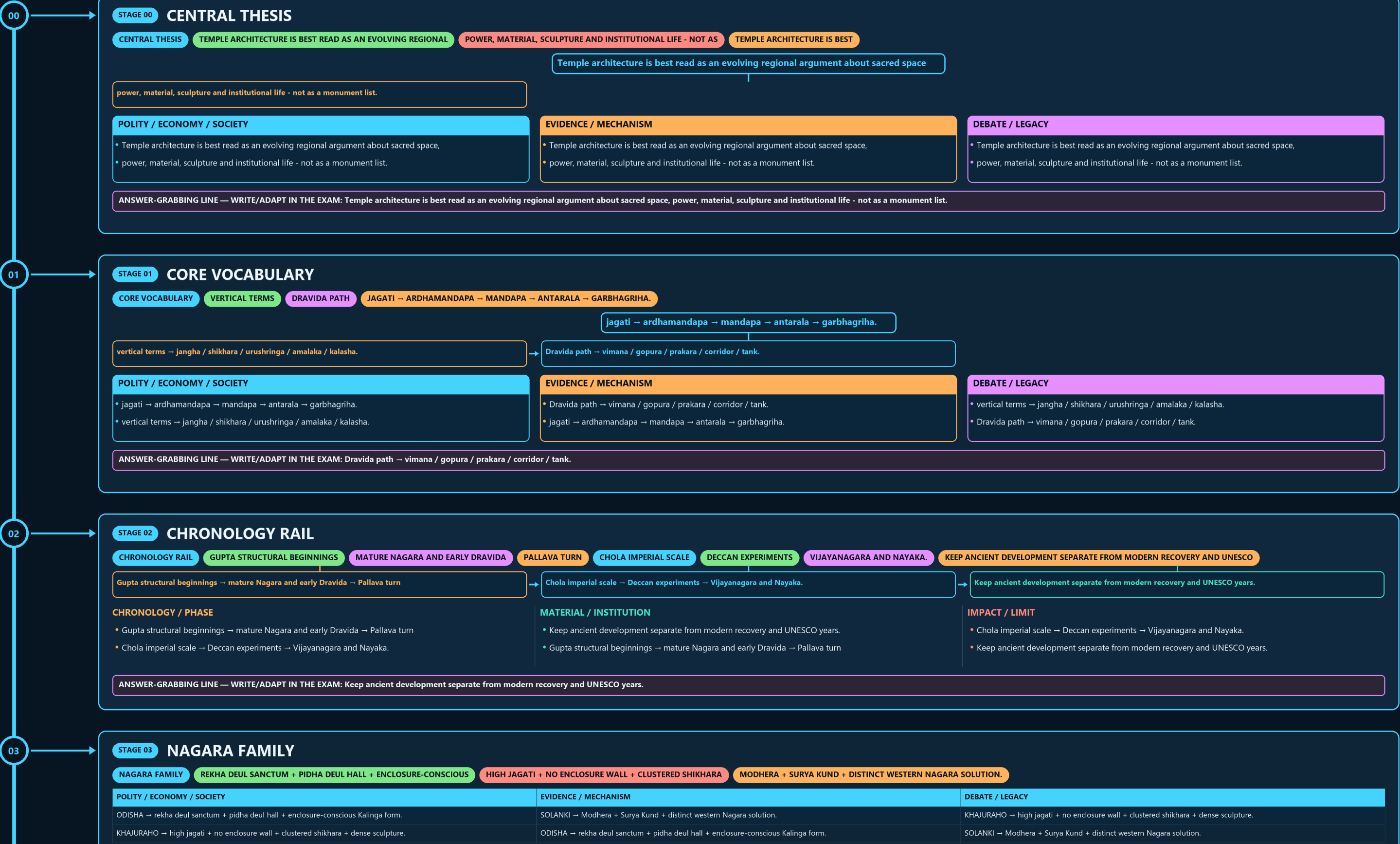
CENTRAL THESIS → CORE VOCABULARY → CHRONOLOGY RAIL → NAGARA FAMILY → PALLAVA TO CHOLA → DECCAN CAUTION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



- Chola imperial scale → Deccan experiments → Vijayanagara and Nayaka.
- Keep ancient development separate from modern recovery and UNESCO years.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Keep ancient development separate from modern recovery and UNESCO years.

STAGE 03 NAGARA FAMILY

MODHERA + SURYA KUND + DISTINCT WESTERN NAGARA SOLUTION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
ODISHA → rekha deul sanctum + pidha deul hall + enclosure-conscious Kalinga form.	SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.	KHAJURAHO → high jagati + no enclosure wall + clustered shikhara + dense sculpture.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.

STAGE 04 PALLAVA TO CHOLA

WRITE ARCHITECTURE WITH BRONZES, MURALS AND INSCRIPTIONS TOGETHER.

Pallava → rock-cut cave → monolithic ratha → structural temple.

Chola → early shrines → Brihadishvara climax → later gopura emphasis.

→ Rule → write architecture with bronzes, murals and inscriptions together.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rule → write architecture with bronzes, murals and inscriptions together.

STAGE 05 **DECCAN CAUTION**

AIHOLE = INCUBATOR.

Aihole = incubator.

Badami = refinement.

- ➔ **Pattadakal = Nagara and Dravida evidence on one site.**

→ Vesara = useful label only after morphology is described.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
- Aihole = incubator. - Badami = refinement.	- Pattadakal = Nagara and Dravida evidence on one site. - Vesara = useful label only after morphology is described.	- Aihole = incubator. - Badami = refinement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vesara = useful label only after morphology is described.

STAGE 06 HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA

BOTH PROVE THAT MATERIAL AND ENGINEERING MATTER, NOT STYLE

HOYSALA → soapstone + stellate jagati + zig-zag walls + lathe-turned pillars.

KAKATIYA → Thousand Pillar and Ramappa → sandbox technique + named architect.

→ Both prove that material and engineering matter, not style labels alone.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

DEBATE / LEGACY

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06

STAGE 06 HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA

HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA

SOAPSTONE + STELLATE JAGATI + ZIG-ZAG WALLS + LATHE-TURNED

THOUSAND PILLAR AND RAMAPPA

SANDBOX TECHNIQUE + NAMED ARCHITECT.

BOTH PROVE THAT MATERIAL AND ENGINEERING MATTER, NOT STYLE

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07

STAGE 07 VIJAYANAGARA AND NAYAKA

VIJAYANAGARA AND NAYAKA

CHARIOT STREETS + MANDAPAS + RAYA GOPURAM + SACRED-ROYAL

CONCENTRIC ENCLOSURES + GRADED GOPURAS + TANKS + PRAKARAMS

VISUAL EMPHASIS SHIFTS FROM VIMANA TO GATEWAY AND CORRIDOR

Vijayanagara → chariot streets + mandapas + Raya gopuram + sacred-royal city.

Nayaka → concentric enclosures + graded gopuras + tanks + prakarams + stucco.

Mechanism → visual emphasis shifts from vimana to gateway and corridor system.

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08

STAGE 08 TEMPLE AS INSTITUTION

TEMPLE AS INSTITUTION

RITUAL + PATRONAGE + ENDOWMENT + FESTIVAL + ADMINISTRATION

USE INSCRIPTIONS, MERCHANT-GUILD TRACES AND NAMED ARTISANS.

DO NOT TREAT TEMPLE EVIDENCE AS A FULL SOCIAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ritual + patronage + endowment + festival + administration + craft labour.
- Use inscriptions, merchant-guild traces and named artisans.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Do not treat temple evidence as a full social census.
- ritual + patronage + endowment + festival + administration + craft labour.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Use inscriptions, merchant-guild traces and named artisans.
- Do not treat temple evidence as a full social census.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not treat temple evidence as a full social census.

09

STAGE 09 CHANDELLA AND KHAJURAHO DOSSIER

CHANDELLA AND KHAJURAHO DOSSIER

CHANDELLA ASSERTION

KHAJURAHO CLUSTERS.

MOST TEMPLES SANDSTONE; CHAUSATH YOGINI, BRAHMA AND MAHADEVA ARE

KHAJURAHO CHAUSATH YOGINI MUST BE KEPT SEPARATE FROM THE

KANDARIYA MAHADEVA

CULMINATION OF TOWER, WALL AND SCULPTURE INTEGRATION.

Jejabhukti / Bundelkhand → Chandella assertion → Khajuraho clusters.

Most temples sandstone; Chausath Yogini, Brahma and Mahadeva are granite exceptions.

Khajuraho Chausath Yogini must be kept separate from the circular Morena example.

Kandariya Mahadeva = culmination of tower, wall and sculpture integration.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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STAGE 10

KHAJURAHO IMAGERY CAUTION

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BREADTH OF LIFE

DEITIES, WORSHIPPERS, TEACHERS, DANCERS, MUSICIANS, COURTLY LIFE.

EROTIC IMAGERY

REAL BUT ONLY ONE REGISTER AMONG MANY.

DO NOT REDUCE THE SITE TO SEXUALITY OR INVENT

breadth of life → deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly life.

erotic imagery → real but only one register among many.

Do not reduce the site to sexuality or invent unsupported percentages.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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DEBATE / LEGACY

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not reduce the site to sexuality or invent unsupported percentages.

STAGE 11

PYQ ROUTE AND CLOSE

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SCULPTURE AS SELECTED SOCIAL EVIDENCE.

PALLAVA CONTRIBUTION; CHOLA ACHIEVEMENT.

VIGOR + BREADTH OF LIFE AT KHAJURAHO.

2021 AND 2026 PRELIMS

CONCEPT ANALYSED, ANSWER WITHHELD PENDING OFFICIAL KEY.

2022 → sculpture as selected social evidence.

2024 → Pallava contribution; Chola achievement.

2025 → vigor + breadth of life at Khajuraho.

2021 and 2026 prelims → concept analysed, answer withheld pending official key.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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DEBATE / LEGACY

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EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

1. CLASSIFICATION CAUTION

2. KHAJURAHO INTERPRETIVE CAUTION

3. SOCIAL-HISTORY CAUTION

4. CONSERVATION CAUTION

NAGARA, DRAVIDA AND VESARA ARE ANALYTICAL TOOLS, NOT CIVILISATIONAL

THE DECCAN ESPECIALLY REQUIRES MORPHOLOGY BEFORE LABEL

PATTADAKAL, HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA EVIDENCE RESISTS NEAT BOXING.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

1. CLASSIFICATION CAUTION

2. KHAJURAHO INTERPRETIVE CAUTION

3. SOCIAL-HISTORY CAUTION

4. CONSERVATION CAUTION

ADVANCED DEBATE

Nagara, Dravida and Vesara are analytical tools, not civilisational cages. Use them after describing plan, tower, material and enclosure logic.

The Deccan especially requires morphology before label: Pattadakal, Hoysala and Kakatiya evidence resists neat boxing.

Erotic imagery at Khajuraho has invited Tantric, symbolic, didactic and worldly-life interpretations.

The source-safe line is that multiple interpretations exist and no single

LEGACY / NUANCE

explanation should be presented as conclusively proven from the sculptures alone.

Temple sculpture is selected representation shaped by patrons, artisans and sectarian goals.

It is excellent for showing valued registers of life, but weak for measuring ordinary social frequency, demographic spread or non-elite experience.

UNESCO's Khajuraho brief works at the level of the inscribed property and its clusters.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.